on soldiers' wrists. 'This is to increase emotional bonding both ways to increase patriotism,' Jog added. Naturally, all ABVKA schools teach the Saraswati Vandana (an ode to the Hindu goddess of learning) and impart Hindu cultural messaging.

Table 14.1: Vanvasi Kalyan Ashram Network of Schools Nationwide

Year	*Schools*	*Students*	*Workers, full-time*	*Workers, part-time*	*Villages*	*Districts*
1992	-	-	563	-	11,000	119
2015	4,460	1,25,415	820	650	-	-
2019	4,190	1,40,459	926	853	1,88,124	674

Source: Akhil Bharatiya Vanvasi Kalyan Ashram Service Projects Information, http://kalyanashram.org/service-project-at-a-glance/

When I asked Jog what had changed in ABVKA schools over the last few years, he said that their main challenge earlier had been to get students to graduate. The baseline for academic performance had shifted upwards significantly in recent years. Speaking on the phone from the capital of Jharkhand, he excitedly pointed out that, of the 1,249 Class XII students in twenty-five ABVKA schools in the state, 68.5 per cent had scored a first division, 22.4 per cent a second division and 1.2 per cent a third division in 2020. One of the girl students, Abha Kumari from Betalsood village, ranked eighth in Jharkhand. 'Earlier, for our children, passing Class X was big, graduating college was even bigger,' he said. 'Now they are getting selected in medical schools, engineering and IITs.'

In fact, the ABVKA's focus now is on training schoolchildren for competitive examinations in different sectors including government, banking and engineering. In early 2020, three of its students—Prashant Hendrm, Manisha Tirkey and Pankaj Bhagat—cleared the Jharkhand Public Service Commission examination and qualified to join the state civil service. In Chhattisgarh's Bilaspur district in 2013 alone, fifty-five ABVKA students qualified for different levels of government. 'Each of them was the first in their families to ever get a government job,' said Jog. Ensuring post-education recruitment for